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COMMENTS:

1.0 Introduction

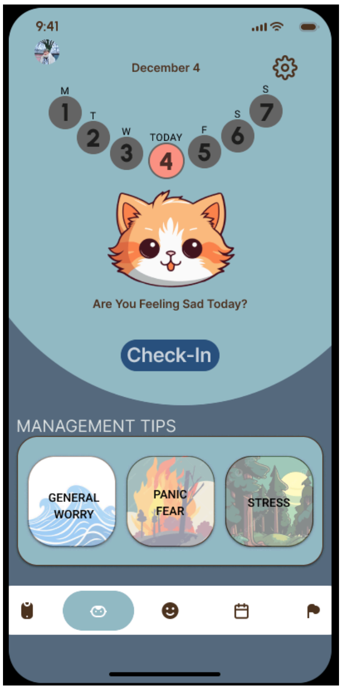
In this report, a heuristic evaluation of MellowMind which is a mobile application designed to support university students in managing stress and anxiety during academically demanding periods is conducted. The evaluation is conducted based on Nielson's 10 Usability Heuristic with the aim of identifying usability issues that may affect the overall user experience and emotional well-being of users.

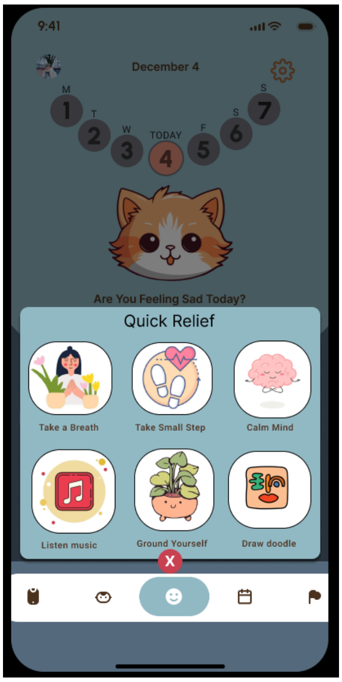
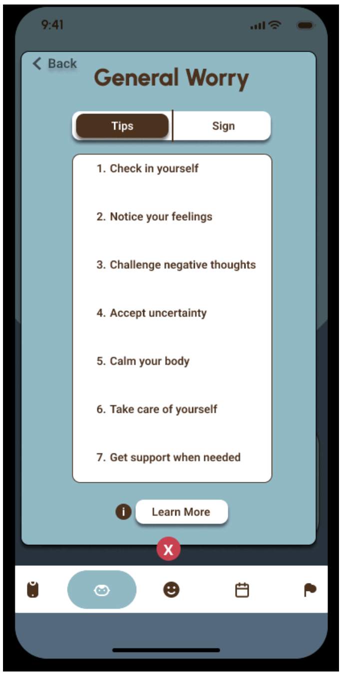
In the evaluation, we focus on the perspective of a target user persona named Fatin. Fatin is a 21 years old computer science student who frequently experiences academic stress and anxiety. Based on the defined persona, scenario and user tasks provided in the design document, this evaluation examines how effectively the interface supports users in completing key tasks such as quick emotional relief, anxiety management, mood check in and profile interaction.

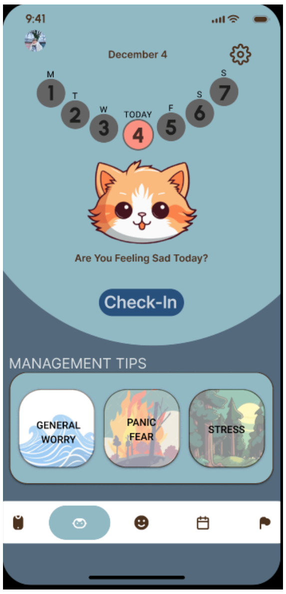
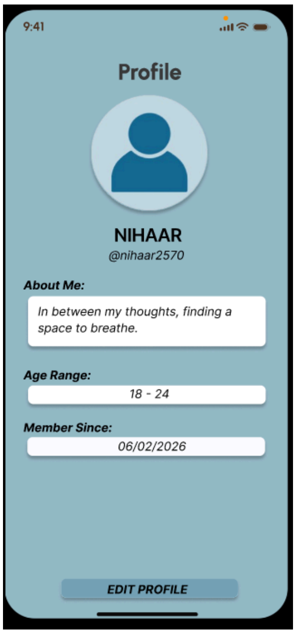
To ensure a structured and comprehensive analysis, usability issues identified during the evaluation are summarized in the Heuristic Evaluation (HE) Table. This highlights the violated heuristics, problem descriptions, severity ratings and suggested improvements. In addition, User Journey Map is included to illustrate the user interaction flow throughout the application, helping to visualize pain points, confusion and emotional responses during task completion.

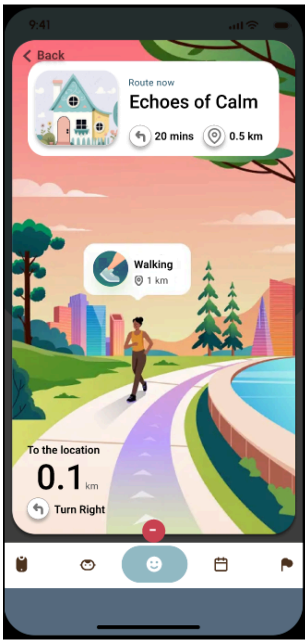
By combining both the HE Table and the User Journey Map, this will provide a clear understanding of how MellowMind performs in terms of usability, clarity, feedback and consistency as well as how these factors impact the user's overall experience. The findings aim to support design improvements that enhance usability while maintaining the app's goal of providing a calm, supportive and user friendly mental wellness platform.

2.0 Heuristics and Evaluation (HE) Results

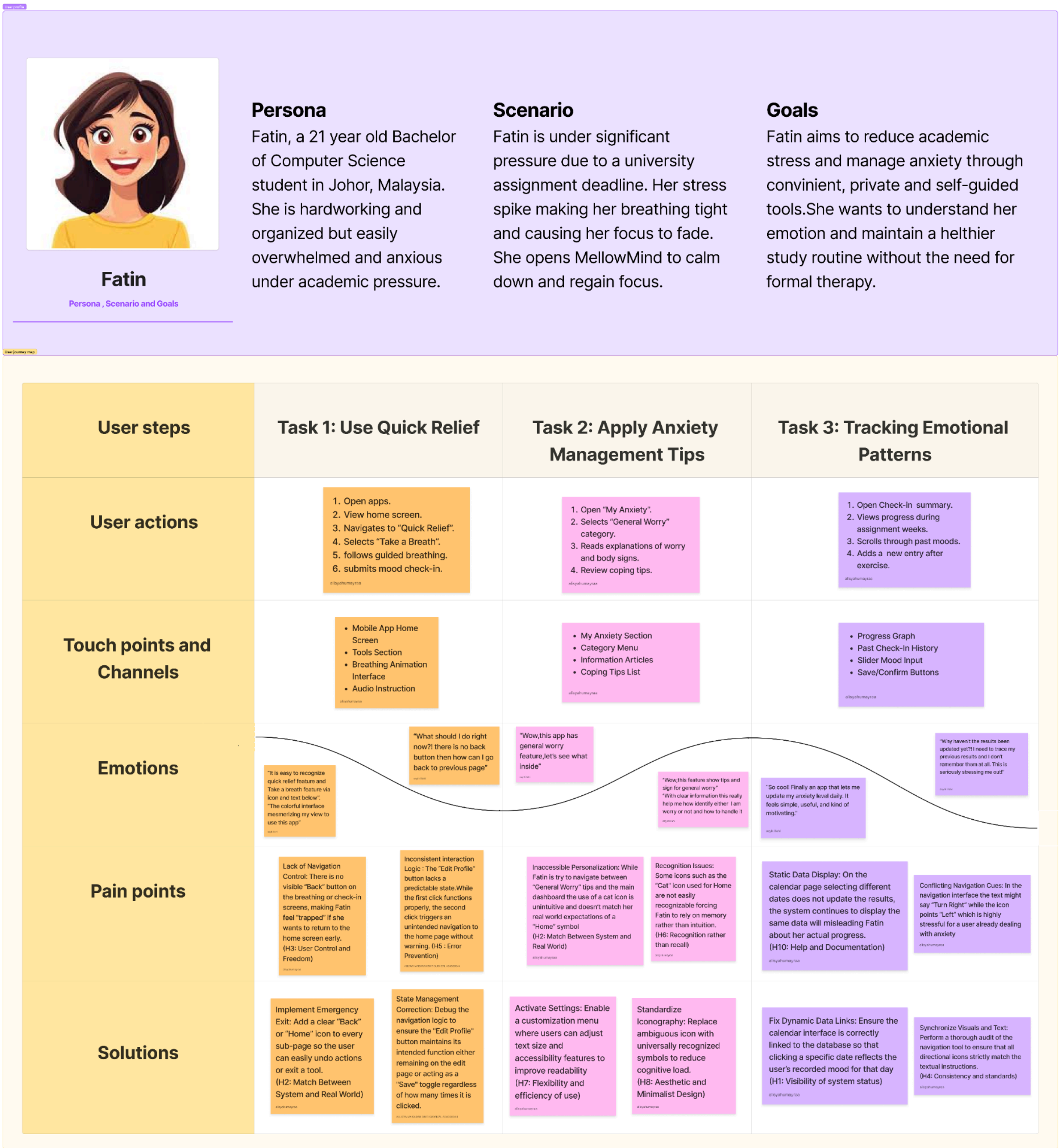
Number	Prototype Image	Identified User	Heuristic and Severity
1		The application does not provide sufficient user control and freedom. There is no visible back button available on several pages, making it difficult for users to undo actions or return to the previous screen. Additionally, some buttons appear clickable but do not function as expected. This may cause users to feel trapped within the interface and increase frustration, especially when they make mistakes or want to change their actions.	H3: User Control and Freedom S3 – Major Issue
2		The interface contains elements that are not fully optimized for a minimalist design. Some screens appear cluttered with unnecessary visual elements and lack proper spacing, which may distract users from the main content. This reduces visual clarity and can overwhelm users, especially those who prefer a clean and simple interface.	H8: Aesthetic and Minimalist Design S2 – Minor Issue

3		The application does not provide any form of help or documentation to assist users. There is no help button, tutorial, or guidance for first-time users to understand how the system works. This can be problematic for new users, as they may struggle to navigate or use certain features without external assistance, leading to poor user experience.	H10: Help and Documentation S3 – Major Issue
4		Some system labels and features do not fully match real-world user expectations. For example, the “Learn More” button does not clearly indicate what type of information will be displayed after it is selected. This may confuse users, as the wording is vague and does not reflect familiar real-world language or actions, reducing overall usability.	H2: Match Between the System and the Real World S2 – Minor Issue

5		The home button is shown as a cat icon which is not a commonly recognized symbol for navigation. This will confuse new users as they must remember the function of the icon instead of recognizing it instantly. Additionally, the placement of the Home button is not ideal at all. Home button typically positioned at the left most side or center of the navigation bar. This will lead to more confusion especially to first time users.	H6: Recognition rather than recall S2: Minor issue
6		The user allows users to make an unintended action without any prevent or warning due to the edit profile button. When the user presses the edit button for the first time, it works as intended. However if the user presses the edit profile the second time the system unexpectedly navigates back to the Home page. This can cause confusion and may lead to accidental loss of changes even though the user did not intend to leave the profile page.	H5: Error prevention S4: Catastrophic issue

7		On the calendar page, the most recent recorded date is December 4. However when users select dates after or before December 4, the system continues to display the same results. This indicates that the system does not update or reflect the user's actual selection. This as a result will mislead the user about the system state. This can cause confusion and frustration.	H1: Visibility of system status S3: Major issue
8		In the navigation interface, the system states that the user needs to turn right after 0.1 km. However, the directional icon displayed indicates a left turn. This inconsistency between textual instructions and visual cues can confuse users and make it more difficult to determine the correct direction. This can potentially cause users to make navigation errors.	H4: Consistency and standard S3: Major issue

3.0 User Journey Map



FigJam link : [User Journey Maps – FigJam]()